

WHY ARE WE ADDICTED TO TECH?

Technology is a hell of a drug.

Mithun Mohandas | mithun@digit.in

A raised eyebrow. That's how most of us reacted when we heard of technology addiction a couple of years back when the term first surfaced. Some of us were whiling away on a couch listening to music on our MP3 players channeled into our ears via the latest IEMs. All the while playing some game or the other on our smartphones. And why were we lounging? Because Steam hadn't finished downloading the latest video game that had come out just a few days back. Honestly, the first time this writer first came across the term was when his parents accused them of being addicted to technology.

Whether this is the first time you're hearing about it or the umpteenth, technology addiction is very much real, and you don't have to look far to find someone who suffers from it – just look in the mirror! In case a wave of disbelief passed over you right now, allow us to list a few symptoms, so that you can see how far down the rabbit hole you've gone.

ARE WE ADDICTED TO TECHNOLOGY?

Technology addiction is an umbrella term that describes a host of behaviours, inflictions, injuries, etc., which

may be present individually or in a combination. It's not easy to recognise when you're starting out, as is the case with any sort of addiction, be it technology or narcotics or other harmful vice which have gained common acceptance (smoking and alcohol consumption, for example). As with every other addiction, it's difficult to identify and even more difficult to accept.

Here's a simple checklist. Have you:

- Felt uneasy or anxious while away from a smartphone, tablet, or PC?
- Lost track of time or events in the real world while engrossed with an electronic device?

- Had an uneasiness emanating from the constant urge to get back to your electronic device?
- Found it easier to reach for a smartphone or device rather than deal with a pressing matter?
- Felt withdrawal symptoms upon being removed from your device?
- Felt moody or depressed upon attempting to or after having cut down on internet use?

These symptoms don't necessarily point to just one cause, but if you face these symptoms, then you, we are sorry to inform you, are very much addicted to technology!



Technology addiction, the most common kind.